

SURAJ HEMNANI

Backend / Platform Engineer

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SUMMARY

I am a backend/platform engineer developing a SaaS solution for UK accounting processes. I maintain integration with four accounting providers (Xero, QuickBooks Online, FreeAgent, Sage), the pipeline for asynchronously publishing real client documents to those providers, and all the AWS infrastructure it runs on, including the service code in Python.

KEY SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, JavaScript
- **Backend:** Django, FastAPI, REST APIs, Celery, async processing, DDD, distributed processing
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, Aurora, MySQL, Redis
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, Elastic Beanstalk, VPC, Aurora, RDS Proxy, ElastiCache, Lambda, SQS, S3, CloudFront, WAF, IAM, Secrets Manager, CloudWatch), Docker, GitHub Actions, Nginx, DigitalOcean
- **Integrations:** Xero, QuickBooks Online, FreeAgent, Sage, Nango, OAuth, webhooks, rate-limit-aware workflows

WORK EXPERIENCE

Associate Software Developer, Peakeaze OPC

April 2025 – Present

- Xero, QuickBooks Online, FreeAgent and Sage integrations on our own provider-agnostic layer using Nango, built around sync, transformation, storage, tax calculations and publishing.
- Asynchronous bulk publishing supporting 50 documents/minute through document grouping and checkpointing, per-provider rate limiting, retries, multistep workflows, tracking and real-time progress updates.
- Achieved sub-second API performance by profiling and resolving compute and infrastructures-related bottlenecks: migrated to C7 instances, scaled up the workers and redesigned the Redis and database deployment.
- Conceived and set up the AWS stack for production environments: VPC, Elastic Beanstalk/EC2, Aurora, RDS Proxy, ElastiCache, SQS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront/WAF, IAM and CloudWatch.
- Own GitHub Actions QA to UAT deployments, Docker builds and AWS Secrets Manager configurations and rollbacks; reduced container image size from 900MB to 600MB.
- Designed the Query domain model of accountant-client queries mapped to bookkeeping documents and built its backend implementation.
- Responsible for handling production incidents on customer live accounting data; resolved the majority of escalation issues myself at the integration, publishing and infra layers.
- Lead design of solutions and features for the ongoing Django to FastAPI transition, checking the implementations for architectural soundness; owner of the DigitalOcean/laC platform.

Software Developer Intern

March 2024 – April 2025

- Worked on implementing the Django backend and React frontend for an accounting-oriented application; handled Linode server and Azure Repos deployment and development operations

EDUCATION

B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering

2021 – 2025

Jhulelal Institute of Technology

- 1st Runner-Up, JSW Science Conclave | Technical Co-Incharge, Encypherist | Webmaster, ACM Student Chapter

PERSONAL PROJECT

- **Forge** – centralized context bank for organizations, enabling feature-based context ownership and controlled context access across teams and agents; designed the underlying data model, lifecycle, authorization model and agent interface.
- **Personal Infrastructure Lab** – self-hosted infrastructure on Raspberry Pi and RHEL with automated deployments/backups, networking, firewalling, SSL, access controls, Suricata IDS and eBPF monitoring.
- **PolicyEngine** – real-time business rule validation engine on a distributed control-plane/worker-node architecture, with automated violation detection and context correlation.

COMMUNITY & SPEAKING

Technical Speaker — JIT ACM Student Chapter

- **Linux 101**: Delivered a session on Linux fundamentals and command-line usage for students.
- **Docker Masterclass**: Delivered a session covering Docker, Linux basics, containerization, and their use in backend and DevOps workflows.